

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-31

Project Closure Report

Formal closure, final acceptance and handover to operations

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Project Closure Report
Document reference	PMB-31-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-03	Benefits Management Plan	Benefit tracking handed over
PMB-30	Lessons Learned Register	Source of lessons
PMB-01	Project Charter	Objectives assessed against
P2-23	End Project Report	PRINCE2 equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Records the formal closure of the project — final performance against baselines, acceptance of deliverables, transition to operations, outstanding items, lessons and the release of resources.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Integration Management — Close Project or Phase
Created when	At the end of the project or a phase
Reviewed / updated	Not applicable — a terminal document
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	This is also the template for premature closure. Where a project is terminated early, record what has been salvaged and what has been done with partly completed work.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Final performance is stated against the original baseline as well as the latest
- Acceptance is formally recorded by the named accepters
- Outstanding items have owners outside the project — nothing is left with a team that no longer exists
- Benefit tracking is formally handed over with a named owner and a review date
- Lessons are transferred, not merely listed

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1. Closure summary

Field	Detail
Project	WS5 MLOps and developer experience
Closure type	Normal / Premature
Start date	01 Sep 2026
Closure date	30 Jul 2027
Project manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Sponsor	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO

2. Objectives achieved

Ref	Objective	Success criterion	Achieved ?	Evidence	Commentary
OBJ-01	Three tenants can run concurrently on hall A with fair-share quota enforced under contention	Quota holds within 5% for each tenant across a 72-hour contention test	9	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Delivered and demonstrated at the PI 4 system demo
OBJ-02	Low-priority training jobs can be pre-empted and resumed without loss of work	A pre-empted 64-GPU job resumes from checkpoint with no data loss	5	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Partially met — resume works for framework-native checkpointing only
OBJ-03	Only signed container images from the internal registry can run on the estate	Unsigned image admission refused and alerted within 30 seconds	9	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Delivered; closes a Tranche 1 assurance finding
OBJ-04	Nodes failing firmware attestation are quarantined automatically at admission	A node with modified firmware is refused and quarantined without human action	0	Configuration management database	Not started — deferred to PI 5 following the vendor attestation API change
OBJ-05	Each tenant receives a monthly consumption statement that reconciles to telemetry	Statement reconciles to raw telemetry within 2% for three consecutive months	8	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Delivered; first statements issued to Finance in November
OBJ-06	GPU telemetry is available at 10-second resolution with 13-month retention	Telemetry present at stated resolution and retention verified by sampling	6	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Delivered; underpins the utilisation benefit measure

3. Performance against baseline

Dimension	Original baseline	Final baseline	Actual	Variance to original	Explanation
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.
Schedule	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for	AED 118,000,000	AED 118,000,000	AED 118,000,000 for	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of

Dimension	Original baseline	Final baseline	Actual	Variance to original	Explanation
	Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	+5% before escalation
Quality	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full

4. Deliverables and acceptance

Ref	Deliverable	Delivered?	Accepted by	Date	Conditions
DAA-01	Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Yes	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer	31 Jan 2027	Median environment request-to-usable time under two hours across 20 sampled requests
DAA-02	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Partially	L. Haddad, CISO	26 Feb 2027	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs
DAA-03	Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Yes	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	31 Mar 2027	Fair-share quota holds within 5% for each tenant under contention
DAA-04	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	No	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	23 Apr 2027	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs

5. Outstanding items at closure

Every item needs an owner who exists after the project does.

Ref	Item	Type	Owner after closure	Target date	Funding source
OIA-01	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Defect / Change / Risk / Action	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	28 May 2027	Configuration management database
OIA-02	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Regulatory	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	25 Jun 2027	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance

Ref	Item	Type	Owner after closure	Target date	Funding source
OIA-03	Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Technical	V. Chandra, Product Management	18 Sep 2026	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space
OIA-04	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Facilities	M. Verity, Head of P3O	15 Oct 2026	ALM tool — Helios ART board
OIA-05	Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Security	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	30 Nov 2026	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate

6. Transition to operations

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence
Operational documentation delivered	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Yes
Support model in place	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Configuration management database
Training completed	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Partially
Monitoring and alerting configured	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	ALM tool — Helios ART board
Access and licences transferred	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance
Security assurance completed	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	No
Configuration items transferred to the CMDB	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance
Warranty period and terms agreed	Baselined	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Yes

7. Benefits handover

Benefit ref	Benefit	Realised to date	Owner after closure	Next review
BEN-01	Reduced external GPU rental	From Q3 2027	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	26 Feb 2027

Benefit ref	Benefit	Realised to date	Owner after closure	Next review
	<i>spend</i>			
BEN-02	<i>Faster model training cycle time</i>	<i>From Q2 2027</i>	<i>V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement</i>	<i>31 Mar 2027</i>
BEN-03	<i>Improved compute utilisation</i>	<i>From Q3 2027</i>	<i>S. Bhatt, Project Manager</i>	<i>23 Apr 2027</i>
BEN-04	<i>Reduced time to provision AI environments</i>	<i>From Q3 2027</i>	<i>C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner</i>	<i>28 May 2027</i>
BEN-05	<i>Data residency and sovereignty assurance</i>	<i>From Q3 2027</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>25 Jun 2027</i>
BEN-06	<i>New revenue from AI-enabled products</i>	<i>From FY29</i>	<i>A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead</i>	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>

8. Procurement closure

Contract	Supplier	Closed?	Final payment	Outstanding claims	Performance rating
<i>Accelerator vendor (direct)</i>	<i>Accelerator vendor (direct)</i>	<i>26 Feb 2027</i>	<i>AED 4,200,000</i>	<i>0</i>	<i>Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint</i>
<i>Nexora Integration Services</i>	<i>Nexora Integration Services</i>	<i>Open</i>	<i>AED 96,000</i>	<i>2</i>	<i>Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail</i>
<i>Gulf Mechanical and Electrical</i>	<i>Gulf Mechanical and Electrical</i>	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>	<i>AED 11,200,000</i>	<i>1</i>	<i>Assured independently by Cordant Assurance</i>
<i>Parallel storage vendor</i>	<i>Parallel storage vendor</i>	<i>26 Feb 2027</i>	<i>AED 240,000</i>	<i>3</i>	<i>Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board</i>
<i>Cordant Assurance</i>	<i>Cordant Assurance</i>	<i>Open</i>	<i>AED 17,800,000</i>	<i>0</i>	<i>Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above</i>

9. Resource release

Resource	Released to	Date	Handover complete
<i>Programme SharePoint —</i>	<i>Assured independently by</i>	<i>23 Apr 2027</i>	<i>Yes</i>

Resource	Released to	Date	Handover complete
Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Cordant Assurance		
Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000	28 May 2027	No
ALM tool — Helios ART board	Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	25 Jun 2027	Yes
Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Reported through the monthly benefit tracking report	18 Sep 2026	Partially

10. Key lessons

The three to five lessons most worth carrying forward. The full set is in the lessons register.

Ref	Lesson	Recommendation	Transferred to
LL-001	Hardware burn-in took 35 days against a 12-day estimate because firmware verification was performed serially on a single isolated VLAN	Model firmware verification as its own work package with parallel VLAN capacity sized for the shipment rate	PMB-10 WBS Dictionary
LL-002	The rate card decision was deferred twice because Finance and the business units were consulted sequentially rather than together	Convene a single decision workshop with Finance and business unit heads together, with the sponsor present to break deadlock	MSP-11 Programme Governance Approach
LL-003	Engaging vendor performance engineering for two weeks during commissioning lifted all-reduce efficiency from 79% to 84% in the first pass	Budget two weeks of vendor performance engineering per hall as a planned activity, not as a remedial response	PMB-15 Basis of Estimates
LL-004	A critical finding on cluster API exposure was discovered late because the test was scheduled after build completion	Run a security design review at architecture sign-off and a first penetration test at 30% build, not only at completion	MSP-15 Assurance Approach and Plan
LL-005	Fraud Analytics resistance was underestimated because engagement began after the decommissioning decision was announced	Assess attitude against observed behaviour, and engage those losing autonomy before the decision is communicated	PMB-04 Stakeholder Register

11. Records and archive

Record type	Location	Retention period	Owner
Configuration management	Programme SharePoint —	Oct 2026	H. Farrell, Director of

Record type	Location	Retention period	Owner
database	Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance		Infrastructure
Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Nov 2026	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead
Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Q4 2026	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead
ALM tool — Helios ART board	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	PI 4	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect

12. Closure approval

Name	Role	Signature / approval	Date
J. Ferreira, Network Lead	Agile Release Train — all teams	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build	23 Apr 2027
V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	Programme Board	Assured independently by Cordant Assurance	28 May 2027
S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Programme Manager and workstream leads	Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	25 Jun 2027
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	CISO and Security Architect	Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	18 Sep 2026